

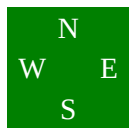
Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ Q J 10 9 4
♣ J 10

♠ 10 5
♥ K Q 10 4
♦ A K 7
♣ K Q 9 8



♠ J 7 6 2
♥ 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 7 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q 9 4
♥ A J 9 7 3
♦ 8 3
♣ A 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

Just hold it a minute and DO NOT say 2♥. True, when partner transfers, you **almost** always just obey and complete the transfer. This is the one time when you don't. You had a 17 point 1NT opener with 4♥s and a doubleton. As soon as partner told you to bid ♥s your hand became worth 18 points because of the good trump support and the doubleton. So you inform partner of this by making the "super-accept" bid of 3♥. In other words, you complete the transfer with a jump.

Partner's eyes get big (but you aren't allowed to notice that) and he bids 4♣.

Partner's ♣ bid was not a suit, you already have an agreed suit, ♥s. The ♣ bid was showing you first round control in ♣s, and is a slam try by partner.

You continue the search for slam by showing your first round ♦ control, you bid 4♦.

That was all partner needed to hear, he jumps straight to 6♥.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 2
 ♥ Q 10 5 3
 ♦ Q J 5 3
 ♣ 10 6 4

♠ Q 9 8 5 3

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4 2

♣ A 3



♠ A K 7
 ♥ J 9 8 6 4
 ♦ 10
 ♣ J 7 5 2

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K

♦ A K 9 7

♣ K Q 9 8

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

You open 2NT and partner responds 3♥.

You bid 3♠, just as partner asked. He puts you in game at 3NT. Bid or pass?

Bid of course. You have an 8-card ♠ fit so you prefer ♠s to notrump.

As you can see, 3NT would surely go down with a ♥ lead, while 4♠ is cold.

One hand doesn't mean it will always be like this, but usually if you have an 8-card fit the Major suit game will be better than 3NT.